



Clean REVOLUTION

Spurred by the growing demand for clean technology, a new generation of Indian entrepreneurs rides green ideas, global capital and fiscal incentives to the future

By Nivedita Mukherjee

What does one do with an old laptop? Probably sell it for a few thousand rupees at the neighbourhood junk dealer who will salvage whatever metal and plastic he can and dump the rest, which contains harmful elements such as lead. But in 2007, Nitin

Gupta, an electrical engineer from IIT-Delhi, and his brother Rohan Gupta, a chemical engineer from REC-Jaipur, had different ideas. They turned their search for environment-friendly ways to dispose of an old laptop into a bigger project aimed at providing eco-friendly solutions to the problem of e-waste—Attero Recycling, India's first end-to-end e-waste management company. If the Guptas saw

business at the bottom of scrap, Vinod Kala's Emergent Ventures sees opportunity in chicken feed waste to produce 1.5 MW power, and Sunil Jain, founder of Green Infra, is banking on LED (Light Emitting Diode) lamps from chips.

Call it business opportunity or fashion, but cleantech start-ups are suddenly in the news, approaching private equity (PE) funds, manufacturing solar panels, setting up solar